

In the **Foundational Stage**, the focus is on building familiarity of students with two spoken Languages (R1 and R2). At the end of this stage, students are expected to read fluently in R1 and comprehend what they read, and begin writing sentences in R1 to express experiences, themes, and what they see in pictures. They gain some familiarity with reading and writing in R2.

In the **Preparatory Stage**, students develop proficiency in speaking, and competencies in reading and writing in both Languages (R1 and R2). While students achieve these faster in R1, they are expected to gain familiarity with R2, gradually progressing from basic communication skills to greater fluency and proficiency in speaking and writing.

By the end of the **Middle Stage**, teachers should aim to achieve similar levels of students' proficiency in both R1 and R2. Some transfer of skills from R1 to R2 enables quicker learning of R2. By the end of this stage, students can understand and appreciate the distinctive features of the language, engage in collaborative discussions, debates, and presentations, analyse and interpret what they read, and write independently with appropriate structure, grammar, vocabulary and creativity.

A new third Language, R3, is introduced in this stage. Students acquire familiarity with the spoken form of this language, along with the basics of reading and writing. They are expected to read various simple texts with comprehension in R3 by the end of the Middle Stage.

Curricular Goals and Competencies

Curricular Goals	Competencies
CG-1 Sustains effective communication skills for day-to-day interactions, enhancing their oral ability to express ideas	1.1 Listens to poems, stories, and conversations and locates important ideas in them
	1.2 Comprehends narrated/read out stories and identifies characters, storyline, and key aspects
	1.3 Converses meaningfully and coherently
	1.4 Makes oral presentations and participates in group discussions

CG-2 Develops fluency in reading and the ability to read with comprehension	2.1 Develops phonological awareness further by blending phonemes/ syllables into words and segmenting words into phonemes/ syllables
	2.2 Examines the basic structure of the text and recognises words and sentences in print and basic punctuation marks
	2.3 Reads stories and passages fluently and accurately with appropriate pauses
	2.4 Comprehends the meaning of stories, poems, and story posters
	2.5 Demonstrates interest in picking up and reading a variety of children's books
CG-3 Develops the ability to express understanding, experiences, feelings, and ideas in writing	3.1 Writes a paragraph to express understanding and experiences
	3.2 Creates simple posters, invites, and instructions with appropriate information and purpose
	3.3 Writes stories, poems, and conversations based on imagination and experiences
CG-4 Develops a wide range of vocabulary in various contexts and through different sources	4.1 Discusses meanings of words and develops vocabulary by listening to and reading a variety of texts in other content areas

Principles of Content Selection

It is important to choose content that is appropriate and relevant to the developmental stages of language learning in students. Inadequate, age inappropriate, and low-quality materials are taking away the value of and joy in language classrooms. Teachers must ensure the use of good quality TLMs, carefully chosen and curated for students across all age groups. This will ensure enthusiasm for learning and foster a connection with the languages being learnt.

2.5.1.1 R1 and R2 in the Preparatory Stage

- a. **For Developing Oracy:** Learning materials that lend themselves to students practising conversation with each other should be chosen. Playful language activities remove the fear of language and induce the fun element into learning. Content should have a variety of